

Class 12

Examples

beyond English:

excavating morphemes

Bontoc (a language spoken in the Philippines Islands)

Data set

[fikas]	‘strong’	[fumikas]	‘he is becoming strong’
[kilad]	‘red’	[kumilad]	‘he is becoming red’
[bato]	‘stone’	[bumato]	‘he is becoming stone’
[fusul]	‘enemy’	[fumusul]	‘he is becoming an enemy’

1. Given [**pusi**] (‘poor’), what would be the most likely meaning of [**pumusi**]?
2. Given [**nitad**] (‘dark’), what would be the most likely form for ‘he is becoming dark’?
3. Given [**pumukaw**] (‘he is becoming white’), what is the most likely form for ‘white’?

Isthmus Zapotec

Data set

[palu]	‘stick’	[spalube]	‘his stick’	[spalulu]	‘your stick’
[ku:ba]	‘dough’	[sku:babe]	‘his dough’	[sku:balu]	‘your dough’
[tapa]	‘four’	[stapabe]	‘his four’	[stapalu]	‘your four’
[geta]	‘tortilla’	[sketabe]	‘his tortilla’	[sketalu]	‘your tortilla’
[bere]	‘chicken’	[sperebe]	‘his chicken’	[sperelu]	‘your chicken’
[doʔo]	‘rope’	[stoʔobe]	‘his rope’	[stoʔolu]	‘your rope’

a. Isolate the morpheme that corresponds to each of the following:

- i. possession (genitive) _____
- ii. 3rd person singular _____
- iii. 2nd person plural _____

b. List the allomorphs corresponding to the following translations:

- i. ‘tortilla’ _____
- ii. ‘chicken’ _____
- iii. ‘rope’ _____

Swedish

Data set

en lampa	‘a lamp’	en bil	‘a car’	stolen	‘the chair’
Bilar	‘cars’	en tidning	‘a newspaper’	Kattarna	‘the cats’
lampan	‘the lamp’	en katt	‘a cat’	bilen	‘the car’
Soffor	‘sofas’	en stol	‘a chair’	Tidningarna	‘the newspapers’
sofforna	‘the sofas’	Bilarna	‘the cars’	katten	‘the cat’
Lamporna	‘the lamps’	tidningen	‘the newspaper’	Stolarna	‘the chairs’
kattar	‘cats’	en sofa	‘a sofa’	tidningar	‘newspapers’
Soffan	‘the sofa’	Lampor	‘lamps’		

- What Swedish word corresponds to the English indefinite article (‘a(n)’)?
- What are the allomorphs of the definite morpheme? Where do they appear?
- How is the indefinite plural formed? The definite plural?
- How would you say the forms of the following words?

		Definite Singular	Indefinite Plural	Definite Plural
en flicka	‘a girl’	_____	_____	_____
en klänning	‘a dress’	_____	_____	_____
en blomma	‘a flower’	_____	_____	_____
en buss	‘a bus’	_____	_____	_____

Examples
beyond English:
Rare in English,
Common Elsewhere

Reduplication

Luganda

Data set

What's the rule?

mutoo	'young'	mutoototoo	'fairly young'
mubii	'bad'	mubiibibii	'rather bad'
mutii	'cowardly'	mutiititii	'rather cowardly'
mubisi	'wet'	mubisibisi	'rather wet'
mugezi	'clever'	mugezigezi	'rather clever'
mulebevu	'slack'	mulebevulebevu	'rather slack'
mugayaavu	'lazy'	mugayaavugayaavu	'rather lazy'

Reduplication : a process whereby an affix is realized by phonological material borrowed from the base.

Examples: goody-goody, wishy-washy, sing-song, roly-poly, harum-scarum

Reduplication is a special case of ordinary affixation morphology, where the affixes are phonologically underspecified, receiving their full phonetic expression by copying adjacent segments (McCarthy 1983:25).

Latin

Data set What's the rule?

Present Form

pend-oo 'I hang (intransitive)'

mord-oo 'I bite'

tond-oo 'I shear'

Perfect Form

pepend-ii 'I have hanged'

momord-ii 'I have bitten'

totond-ii 'I have shorn'

Chinese

Data set

唱歌

chàng-gè

跳舞

tiào-wǔ

跑步

pǎo-bù

洗澡

xǐ-zǎo

What's the rule?

sing-song

jump-dance

run-step

wash-bath

唱唱歌

chàng-chàng-gè

跳跳舞

tiào-tiào-wǔ

跑跑步

pǎo-pǎo-bù

洗洗澡

xǐ-xǐ-zǎo

to sing a little bit

to have a brief dance

to go for a short, casual jog

to take a quick bath/shower

休息

xiū-xi

讨论

tǎo-lùn

学习

xué-xí

批评

pī-píng

rest-stop

seek-discuss

learn-practice

criticize-judge

休息休息

xiū-xi-xi-xi

讨论讨论

tǎo-lùn-tǎo-lùn

学习学习

xué-xí-xué-xí

批评批评

pī-píng-pī-píng

to take a brief rest

to discuss a little bit

to study/learn a bit

to criticize gently/briefly

Binyanim

Arabic

Data set	What's going on?
kataba	'he wrote'
kattaba	'he caused to write'
kaataba	'he corresponded'
takaatabuu	'they kept up a correspondence'
ktataba	'he wrote, copied'
kitaabun	'book (nominative)'
kuttaabun	'Koran school (nominative)'
kitaabatun	'act of writing (nominative)'
maktabun	'office (nominative)'
makaatibu	'offices (nominative)'
kutiba	'it was written'
nkatab	'subscribe'

Data set

come	came
become	became
bring	brought
fight	fought
give	gave
forbid	forbade

foot	feet
goose	geese
mouse	mice

Hebrew

Data set

Past

‘to sit’

		Singular	Plural
1		jaʃavti	jaʃavnu
2	m	jaʃavta	jʃavtem
	f	jaʃavt	jʃavten
3	m	jaʃav	jaʃavu
	f	jaʃva	jaʃavu

‘to write’

		Singular	Plural
1		katavti	katavnu
2	m	katavta	ktavtem
	f	katavt	ktavten
3	m	katav	katvu
	f	katva	katvu

Brain and morphology

Mental lexicon

Brain dictionary

